Unit 12 The Great Race

每句三行：音标 · 原文 · 空行（空行供手写意群标记：⊣ 停顿 ∨ 降调 ∧ 升调）

① ə lɒt əv bɪg ˈsɪtɪz laɪk ˈlʌn.dən hæv gɒt ˈmen.i ˈtræf.ɪk ˈprɔ:bləmz

A lot of big cities, like London, have got many traffic problems.

ˈsʌm.taɪmz ə ˈdʒɜ:.ni əv ə fju: ˈkɪləˌmi:təz kæn teɪk mɔ:r ðən ən aʊər

Sometimes a journey of a few kilometres can take more than an hour.

səʊ wɒts ðə best weɪ tə get əˈkrɒs ˈlʌn.dən

So what's the best way to get across London?

fə ə ˈver.i ʃɔ:t ˈdʒɜ:.ni ɪts ˈprɒb.ə.bli ə gʊd aɪˈdɪə tə wɔ:k

For a very short journey, it's probably a good idea to walk.

bət wɒt ˈhæpənz wen jə wɒnt tə gəʊ ˈfɜ:.ðər

But what happens when you want to go further?

② ðə prɪˈzen.tər əv ə ˈpɒp.jə.lər ˌti:ˈvi: ʃəʊ əˈbaʊt kɑ:z dɪˈsaɪ.dɪd tə faɪnd aʊt

The presenters of a popular TV show about cars decided to find out.

i:tʃ əv ðə prɪˈzen.tər tʃəʊz ə ˈdɪf.ər.ənt taɪp əv ˈtræn.spɔ:t tə meɪk ðə seɪm ˈkɪl.əˌmi:.tər ˈdʒɜ:.ni

Each of the presenters chose a different type of transport to make the same 27-kilometre journey.

wʌn prɪˈzen.tər went baɪ baɪk

One presenter went by bike.

wʌn went baɪ kɑ:r

One went by car.

əˈnʌð.ər tʃəʊz ˈpʌb.lɪk ˈtræn.spɔ:t ðə ˌʌn.dəˈgraʊnd ənd bʌs ənd ðə lɑ:st wʌn ˈtrævld baɪ ˈspi:d.bəʊt ʌp ðə ˈrɪv.ər temz

Another chose public transport – the underground and bus – and the last one travelled by speedboat up the River Thames.

ðeɪ ɔ:l ˈstɑ:tɪd ət ðə seɪm taɪm ənd ðə seɪm pleɪs ɪn west ˈlʌn.dən bət hu: gɒt tə ˈsɪt.i ˈeə.pɔ:t ɪn i:st ˈlʌn.dən ˈfɜ:st

They all started at the same time and the same place in West London, but who got to City Airport in East London first?

③ ðə rɪˈzʌlts wə ə səˈpraɪz

The results were a surprise.

ðə baɪk keɪm ˈfɜːst

The bike came first.

ɪn ˈsek.ənd pleɪs wəz ðə ˈspiːd.bəʊt

In second place was the speedboat.

ˈpʌb.lɪk ˈtræn.spɔːt keɪm θɜːd ənd ðə kɑːr wəz lɑːst

Public transport came third and the car was last.

④ səʊ ðə prɪˈzen.tər həd ən ˈɑːn.sər

So the presenters had an answer.

ðə baɪk wəz ˈkwɪkə(r) ðən ɔːl ðə ˈʌð.ər taɪps əv ˈtræn.spɔːt ənd ðə kɑːr wəz ˈsləʊə

The bike was quicker than all the other types of transport and the car was slower.

ðeɪ wɜːnt ˈver.i ˈhæp.i wɪð ðə rɪˈzʌlt bɪˈkəz ðeɪ ˈwɒntɪd ðə kɑːr tə wɪn

They weren't very happy with the result because they wanted the car to win.

ðeɪ meɪd ə dʒəʊk ənd sed ðə baɪk ˈwɒznt ə rɪəl ˈwɪn.ər bɪˈkəz ɪt wəz mɔːr ˈdeɪn.dʒər.əs

They made a joke and said the bike wasn't a real winner because it was more dangerous.

⑤ bət əv kɔːs ðə baɪk z ðə rɪəl ˈwɪn.ər

But, of course, the bike is the real winner.

ɪts ðə best weɪ tə get əˈbaʊt

It's the best way to get about.

ɪts tʃiːpə ðən ˈpʌb.lɪk ˈtræn.spɔːt ənd ɪt z ˈhel.θi ðən ˈgəʊɪŋ baɪ kɑːr

It's cheaper than public transport and it is healthier than going by car.

ɪts ˈɔːl.səʊ ˈbet.ər fə aʊər ˈsɪtɪz bɪˈkəz baɪks dəʊnt meɪk ðə eər ˈdɜː.ti

It's also better for our cities because bikes don't make the air dirty.

səʊ nekst taɪm jə niːd tə ˈtræv.əl əˈraʊnd θɪŋk bɪˈfɔːr jə ənd jə ˈpeərənts get ˈɪn.tuː ðə kɑːr kæn wiː meɪk ðɪs ˈdʒɜː.ni baɪ baɪk

So next time you need to travel around, think before you and your parents get into the car – 'Can we make this journey by bike?'